TEKS 110.37(5)(C) · ENGLISH II · RESPONSE SKILLS

Commentary Surgery

Use evidence and original commentary to support an interpretation

NAME _____ DATE _____ PER. _____

Directions: 1. Read the passage. 2. Each patient below quotes the passage, but its commentary is sick. Check the diagnosis. 3. Rewrite only the commentary in two or more sentences. **Do not touch the quote.**

The Spare Key

NARRATIVE · 113 WORDS

1 Marisol's grandfather kept a spare key to the shop under a flowerpot that had held nothing but dirt for eleven years. Every morning he lifted the pot, took the key, and set the pot back exactly on its pale ring on the concrete.

2 After the funeral, her mother hired a man to change the locks. "It's not safe, a key under a pot," she said. "Everyone on this street knows."

3 Marisol waited until the locksmith's van pulled away. Then she took the old key from her pocket, the one that no longer opened anything, and slid it back under the pot. She lined the pot up with its ring. She watered the dirt.

STEP 1 **Diagnose each patient, then operate.** (the dotted line is the sick part)

PATIENT A

- ☐ Naked quote
- ☐ Just restates
- ☐ Off the text

Marisol refuses to let go of her grandfather. The story says she took the key, "the one that no longer opened anything, and slid it back under the pot" (¶3). Her mother, on the other hand, wants to move on.

YOUR COMMENTARY

_____

_____

_____

PATIENT B

- ☐ Naked quote
- ☐ Just restates
- ☐ Off the text

Marisol keeps her grandfather's routine alive. She "lined the pot up with its ring" (¶3). This quote means that she put the pot back in the same place where it always was.

YOUR COMMENTARY

_____

_____

_____

PATIENT C

- ☐ Naked quote
- ☐ Just restates
- ☐ Off the text

The key matters to Marisol. Her grandfather "set the pot back exactly on its pale ring" (¶1). I think this is sad because my grandma had routines too, and I miss her.

YOUR COMMENTARY

_____

_____

_____

STEP 2 **Why does Marisol water the dirt? One quote from ¶3, then your commentary.**

_____

_____

Could another reader disagree with your Step 2 answer using the same story? ☐ Yes: it's an interpretation. ☐ No. Keep operating.

§110.37(5)(C) English II. Response skills: the student responds to an increasingly challenging variety of sources that are read, heard, or viewed; use text evidence and original commentary to support an interpretive response.

Rubric (1–3 each): Accurate diagnosis · Quote left untouched · Commentary adds new meaning